

R. Ray Barnes

The Art of Poetry

Volume 3

Thoughts From The Heart



The Art Of Poetry: Thoughts From The Heart

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Volume 3

Thoughts From The Heart

By R. Ray Barnes



R. Ray Barnes Productions

R. Ray Barnes

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R. Ray Barnes Productions
18336 Soledad Canyon Rd Suite 1102 • Canyon Country, CA 91386
Email: info@rraybarnes.com

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The Power Of Uniting In Love

When you inner-connect spiritually with that special someone, that special “true love,” your “soul mate,” the energy created from this spiritual union of love gives birth to a oneness that transforms you and your mate into a single more dynamic source for love and manifestation of love, much greater than either of you could be alone, whose capacity for and capability to love increases exponentially. When this occurs, by virtue of the power and impact inherent in such a fusion of love, it will become the most important occurrence in your life—and could very well be the closest thing you’ll ever experience that mirror and reflects the “first love” that the creator had for humankind.



R. Ray Barnes

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*Especially to my dear wife Diane and my family:
Damon, Christopher, Jordan, Damon Ray, LaDraya, EJ,
Brianna and Isaiah for loving me despite my imperfections.*

*Especially to my parents, Robert, and Yvonne Barnes,
these thoughts are merely an extension of the
love and wisdom that you’ve given me.*

Your love and spirit are always a part of what I do.

I love and thank you with all my heart.

May you rest eternally in peace forever together...

Dedication

To all those who seek true love...

You must always remember and never forget---that you are more than what meets the eye. The essence of your beauty lies within. So don't be afraid to look deep inside to explore the full expanse of your heart and inner soul.

If you dare to undertake the journey, you will find there a boundless treasure of love and great gifts of understanding, patience and trust just waiting for you to discover and claim...

You may have visited your inner essence before at midnight in your dreams and didn't remember its existence.

However, to realize your treasures and receive your wonderful gifts, you must venture there at midday with your subconscious mind wide open to the fullness of the creator's bright light so that you may clearly envision the vast riches that were bequeathed to you.

Once accomplished, if you then share the treasures of that knowledge and understanding wisely, your heart shall be filled with enough love, peace, joy, and happiness to last forever...

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Thoughts From The Heart



A Drop Of Your Love

a drop of your

Love

fell into my stream

of

Loneliness,



and

my heart has been

rippling

with

Joy

ever since...

Always Thinking Of You

feelings come...

feelings go...

yet,

Your Love

Stays-----

and is Always

on my mind,

in my Heart

and deep inside

My Soul

Assets & Liabilities

*The ambitious **Lad***

was told that

to succeed

one must learn

to turn

Liabilities into Assets

*So, the ambitious **Lad***

used his

“Lie” Abilities

to succeed,

and now his

Ass-Is-Set!

Beauty Is

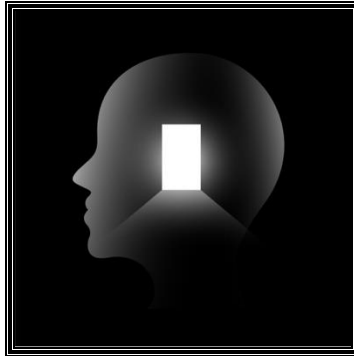
Beauty is

in the eye of those who see

Love.

Upper Door

If
you
Dare
to
Open
your body's
Upper Door
that leads to your
Subconscious Mind
you will enter a world full of
Light, Love, Joy, Peace, & Happiness...



Choices

*You can try to
cross the street
in **Los Angeles**
and you'll have
the right of way...*

or

*You can try to
cross the street
in **New York**
and get your ass
run over...*

Compared To What?

*a Smart Car seems like a Rolls Royce
on a highway full of
Bicycles...*

Dance With The Devil

*if
you're going to
Dance With
The Devil...
you better know how
to do
more than a
Two Step...*



Delicacy

*i've been sailing
around
around around
around around
around around
around
in your sea of love
making
circles
circles circles
circles circles
circles circles
circles
of waves
around
around around
around around
around around
around
your heart...
but now
i've decided to drop my anchor
and go fishing in the sanctity of*

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your sweet waters...
i'm baiting my hook
*with **Love, Joy, & Affection...***
*with **Passion, Tenderness, & Devotion...***
*with **Kindness, Friendship, & Respect...***
i'm casting my line
toward the core of your essence...
and
with a gentle
splash
splash splash
splash splash
splash splash
splash
my hook penetrated your
sacred waters
and i felt your heart
ripple
ripple ripple
ripple ripple
ripple ripple
ripple
as my lure drifted slowly
to the depths of your love...
now,

*i'm waiting patiently
for you to
tug on my
l
i
n
e
so i can reel you in,
set your heart aflame
and feast upon the
Delicacy of your **Love...***

Do I Ever Cross Your Mind?

*And she questioned him saying,
"Do I ever cross your mind when we're not together?"
And in silence he said to himself...*

I THINK OF YOU

*when dawn draws near...
as the sun oozes out of the sea,
creeping across the sky
chasing darkness away...*

'I' Think Of You

I HEAR YOUR VOICE

*when the birds sing...
whistling their morning anthems of love,
chirping sweet melodies
manifesting the beauty of sound...*

'I' Hear Your Voice

I FEEL YOUR TOUCH

*when the dew falls...
touching and kissing softly the flowers,
weeping tears of joy on the leaves of trees,
and licking me all over...*

'I' Feel Your Touch

I SEE YOUR FACE

when dusk closes in...

as the moon works the nightshift,

shining its spotlight on the stars

who all won academy awards for best picture...

'I' See Your Face

but as she looked on

anxiously awaiting his answer,

in a very nonchalant way, he replied...

'Yeah, Sometimes...'

Do You Believe In God?

some

People “Know” God

and can bring forth

God to Act

in their behalf...

while other

People “Believe in” God

and just

hopefully waits for

God to Act

in their behalf...

*do **You** “Believe” in **God***

or

*do **You** “Know” **God**?*

Dollars & Sense

why do we
pay
so much attention
to people who
make
lots of
\$\$\$ DOLLARS \$\$\$
but make
NO
??? SENSE ???

Final Approach

I've been

circling

circling circling

circling circling

circling circling

circling

around

your

HEART

in a

holding pattern

being unable to

land

due to an

old plane

that's

stuck

on your

runway.

But now,

I
have
very little fuel
remaining,
and
soon will be
forced
to make a
FINAL APPROACH

Give And Get

some people

***GIVE** and forgive...*

while others

***GET** and forget.*

God Is Personal

God

*is **personal** and **direct**,
not impersonal and roundabout.*

God

*has no need for
holy ghosts, angels, secret agents
and
invisible spirits
that fly around **detached** from-----**You**
hollow, shapeless and devoid
of form and appearance...*

God

*you find and feel on the
In-side,
not search for and hope to discover on the
Out-side...*

When you are truly touched by

God

*there is a **gnosis** that takes place
that removes the need for you to see
Him or Her*

Moreover,
after you've been truly touched by
God,
holy ghosts, angels, secret agents
and invisible spirits
that fly around detached from-----You
hollow, shapeless and devoid
of form and appearance
Just Won't Do!

God Must Not Be Perfect

*Either all things are **perfect**
or nothing is **perfect**...*

*When
all things are reduced
to their natural origin,
their natural origin
is **God**.*

*And if
God is **perfect**,
then,
He or She
is
incapable of producing
anything save **perfection**!*

*Therefore,
if
imperfection exist,
God created it...*

And
*if **God***
*created anything that is less than **perfect**,*
then,
God
Must Not Be
Perfect...

God Speak

It
is
in
Silence
that
God Speaks the Loudest...
and
She
even
some-
times
Sings!

Her...

Her HEART

was at peace like the heavens...

Her SMILE

was aglow like moonlight...

Her EYES

shined bright like sunshine...

Her SPIRIT

was like a rainbow... and

Her LOVE

was

like Her HEART

like Her SMILE

like Her EYES

like Her SPIRIT...

like

...Her

Her China

*One day she said to me,
"Oh, honey please!
be careful how you handle
My China."*

*So, I became very mindful of
Her China.
However, I never asked her to
be careful in how she handled
My Love.*

*...She broke **My Heart...**
Yet, **Her China**
hasn't a chip nor a scratch.*

***The China**
cost her only \$569.95 on sale
and*

***The Love**
damn near me cost me a
Lifetime-----*

But maybe She got her monies worth,

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*And maybe I invested too much in **Love...***
because,
She still has
Her China.

Holy War

If

I am

Praying

to My God

*to **Kill** you...*

&

you are

Praying

to Your God

*to **Kill** me...*

if

either of Our

Prayers are answered...

does the

Devil win the War?

If God Is Love...?

If
God is Love
and
Love is God
and
God is
synonymous with good...
then,
after being
*in **Love**,*
*with **You***
*why do **I***
feel so bad?

If God Is Perfect...?

if

GOD

is perfect---

how is it possible that

HE

created

.

~

...

~

....

~

.....

~

.....

~

.....

~

.....

~

.....

~

.....

.....US?

Stephen Hawking said,

"We live because of the imperfection of creation."

I think he was right...

If You Come In Love

*If you “come” in **Love**...*

*...you shall go in **Peace**...*

...or is it?

*If you “cum” in **Love**...*

*...you shall go having had **Piece**...*

Illusion

don't come close to me

and not let me

Touch You,

keep your

Distance

and let me

keep my

Illusion

that i can't

Touch You

because you're

just too

Far

✈ ✈ ✈ ✈✈ ✈✈ ✈ ✈ ✈ ✈✈ ✈✈ ✈ ✈ ✈ ✈✈
✈✈ ✈ ✈ ✈ ✈✈

Away

Infinite Voyage

our Love is

like the universe

...it's forever expanding

our Love is

like a shooting star

...it's never

l

a

n

d

i

n

g

but,

our Journey is not without a destination...

for

every moment reveals

A New Place...

every thought unveils

A New Port...

and
every touch gives way to
A New Discovery...

our Love is an INFINITE VOYAGE through
Love & Spirit
Mind & Body
Heart & Soul
Time & Space...
and oh what a
Wonderful Ride!



It's Just Not Enough!

it's just not enough

to say

you Love me...

especially when i need you to

touch me, hold me, love me,

re-assure me...

it's just not enough to say you Love me...

No!

It's Just Not Enough!

Joy To The World

Joy to the World

the Lord has

“Come...?”

...Damn!

Did Monica Lewinsky blow Him

too?

Justified Homicide

People are using

Bibles, Korans & Holy Books

to

Justify Homicide...

Catholics killing Protestants,

Protestants killing Catholics,

Jews killing Arabs,

Arabs killing Jews,

***White** folks killing **Black** folks---*

while

***Black** folks are killing the **Blues**...*

*All---in the name of **God**...*

Maybe we give

God

too much credit

and don't take enough

for ourselves?

Lean On Me

You Apologized

for having to

Lean On Me

in such hard times...

*but you're no **burden**...*

i carry you

in My Heart

*with **My Love***

*and all around **My Being**---*

*you make **Me Smile**...*

even

Leaning

you're more upright

than most...

besides,

you really don't

Weigh *that much...*

Learning

Lessons are about the Past...

Acting is about the Now...

Planning is about the Future...

but,

Learning is all the Time!

Life

*if **Life** is
about what
Is...
then
why do we worry
so much about what
Ain't?*

Life & Death Cycle

Life

is but for the

living

&

living

is but for the

alive

&

Death

is

but for the

dying

&

dying

is

but for the

living...

Life's Harvest

*In
order to reap the benefits of*

Life's Harvest...

One

must

plant the seed

of

Initiative.

Lightspeed

The faster you move towards

*the **Light***

The faster

*the **Light***

moves towards you



Like A Circle

*i can't seem to find the place
where **you** Leave off*

and

*where **i** Begin---*

Like time...

Like space...

Like a circle...



Love

There is

Nothing** else like **Love

and

*else you have **Love***

you have

Nothing.

Love Is A Three Letter Word

*People keep telling me
i'm not spelling **Love** correctly.
They say, love has four letters,
however, i beg to differ---because for me,
L. is for,*

*All the
Long Nights
that i sit up
writing lovely things about
you, you, and only
YOU.*

***O.** is for,
Oh how beautiful
your brown eyes...
Oh how pretty
your smile...
Oh how tender
your touch...
Oh how sweet
your kiss...
Oh how kind
your heart...
and*

Oh *how*
Outstanding

YOU

are.

V. *is for,*

My

Vital Signs,

that seem to rise,

every time i see your face, hear your voice

or even fan-ta-size about being with

YOU.

E. *is for,*

that

Everlasting

*warm feeling of **Ecstasy** that comes over me,*

whenever i merely imagine

sharing the rest of my life with

YOU.

So, you see, every time

I spell Love

it comes out

Y O U

Love Suite

*There is a
Love Suite
at the
penthouse of my heart
that's only been
visited by you
and
is still
reserved
with
your name attached...
and
has not been
occupied
since.*

Me Without You

<i>A Kitten</i>	<i>without its purr</i>
<i>A Mink</i>	<i>without its fur</i>
<i>A Child</i>	<i>who has lost their favorite toy.</i>
<i>A Bird</i>	<i>without its wings</i>
<i>A Bag Lady</i>	<i>without her things</i>
<i>A Clown</i>	<i>who can't summon up a smile.</i>
<i>A Right</i>	<i>without its wrong</i>
<i>A Singer</i>	<i>without a song</i>
<i>A Body</i>	<i>who can't seem to find its soul.</i>
<i>A Poem</i>	<i>without its rhyme</i>
<i>A Clock</i>	<i>without its time</i>
<i>A Heart</i>	<i>which has begun to lose its beat.</i>
<i>A Spring</i>	<i>without its flowers</i>
<i>An April</i>	<i>without its showers</i>
<i>And Me</i>	<i>without being in love</i>

With You...

Men vs. Women

MEN

tend to follow the line of least resistance...

WOMEN

tend

to

resist

to

follow

any

line...

My Baptism

i've been crying

a lot...

lately, early on,

and

right smack dab in the middle

of all these lonely days...

ever since she left

i keep wondering...

was i really so bad

that she just had to leave?

Or,

was she really that good

that i just miss her so much?

So,

i Prayed, Meditated, and Chanted

for an answer---

but none came...

now

My Tears

have inundated

My Spirit---

My Heart

has been drowned by

My Sorrow---

and

My Love

did not survive...

however, i have come

to realize that tears can

be very cleansing...

so, from

this moment forth...

My Tears

will be

My Baptism...

and along with

My Faith,

i know that

Love for me will be Born Again.

My God's Better Than Your God

(Sung to the tune of the 1960's Ken-L TV Commercial)

Melody by Tom Paxton

"My God's

better than your

God,

My God's

better than yours...

My God's

better 'cause he gets Ken • L Ration

My God's

better than yours."

Oops, pardon me,

I'm a little

Dyslexic,

I really meant

"My Dog."

New Birth

i was walking around my mind today
&
i stumbled upon a book on love
&
it was opened to our chapter---
so i picked it up
&
rushed to see how it ended...
but, as i turned the pages frantically,
each page gave birth to another, & another, & another...
&
i have been in constant labor
trying to
decipher, unravel,
figure out, comprehend
&
grasp
the meaning & mystery
contained on each new page
of our everlasting
Love Story.
however, now i realize,
i need only to sit back, relax

&

*accept the blessings of
our continuing*

New Birth...

&

*understand that
with the **nurturing**
comes the*

Revelation...

No Faith Needed

there is

No Faith Needed---

either you

Know God

or you don't!

Faith

is only needed

regarding

things you don't know...

So, please don't try to

pawn your doubts off on me---

i have enough doubts

of my own,

however,

“Knowing God”

is not one of them!

Now Hear This!

you seem always to

Hear

everything i say---

and on most occasions

you can quote me,

-time and date

-word for word

-phrase for phrase...

however.

you seem never

to really

Listen.

Nutcracker Sweet

Love

may seem a

Hard

&

Bitter Nut

to crack...

But,

once you get inside

and savor it's

Sweet

&

Tender Meat---

It'll

have you

Cuming & Going...

Pagan & Uncivilized

*After analyzing
the **history** and **affairs**
of the so called
"Religious
God Fearing
Civilized
Western Man"
and
the manner in which
he
has come to treat
others and nature...
I
gladly choose to count
Myself
among the
"Pagan & Uncivilized"*

Picture Window

don't allow anyone 2 put

Blinds, Shades, Curtains, or Drapes

on your

Minds' Picture Window...

let all

The Creator's Light Shine Through...

P.S.

*...you may even want to consider a **Skylight***

Point - Of - View

Lakes look like Seas---

Seas look like Oceans---

it all depends on your

POINT - OF - VIEW

*one must **Rise** above...*

To See, To Realize, To Know

that there is a difference!

Revelation

everyone is trying to find

GOD

as if

GOD

went

AWOL

or was

Missing In Action

but no one seems to know

quite where to look...

they've been

searching

ancient text

to see if

GOD

indeed walked among us

and

wondering if, and when

GOD

will come again. but,

if you truly want to find

GOD

just calm yourself,

be still, meditate, focus, listen closely, look

d

e

e

p

inside,

and

GOD

will be

REVEALED

to you...

in person,

in the flesh,

In the Mirror.

GOD

is a part of

YOU

Inseparable & Indivisible

AWOL - Military term meaning "absent without leave."

Rusty Lamp

i was just an old

RUSTY LAMP---

sitting in the corner

covered with dust...

---then you came along...

dusted me off and

Turned Me On...

and

I Thank You

for putting the

Light

back into

My Life.

Senses

If only i could

See Me

via your beautiful brown eyes

Then, i would know exactly how to

Look

to turn you on.

If only i could

Feel Me

via your soft & gentle hands

Then, i would know exactly how to

Touch

your smooth & silky body.

If only i could

Hear Me

via your tender & receptive ears

Then, i would know exactly how to

Whisper

sweet, sensuous things

to you all night long...

If only i could

Smell Me

via your keen & sensitive nose

Then, i would know exactly which

Fragrance

stimulates your sexual proclivities.

If only i could

Taste Me

via your red hot luscious lips

Then, i would know exactly how to

Kiss You

so that you could savor the flavor forever...

If only i could

See, Feel, Hear, Smell,

&

Taste Me

via

You---

Shadow Dancing

when i'm feeling lonely

& Missing You ...

i turn on my light and dance with

My Shadow.

even though i'm not such a great dancer

My Shadow

never complains...

My Shadow

follows-----every move i make

& every little step i take.

even when i make a mistake

My Shadow

never steps on my feet, never gets tripped-up

& never tires of my avant-garde dance.

sometimes,

My Shadow

plays hide and seek with me,

it dashes out far ahead making me give chase,

then it may peek at me from side 2 side

& on some days, it sneaks up on me from behind

but, even on June 21st at high noon---i know

My Shadow

is still there...
i have never doubted
***My** Shadow, & **My** Shadow*
has always stood by me,
i guess you could say we were a match made in heaven...

but as much as i love
***My** Shadow*
every time i turn out my light
i still wish that
***My** Shadow*
was
You.

Silent Conversations

i am learning to

Speak

with my

Mind...

without my mouth

without words

without gestures

without smoke signals

without drums

without sound...

noiseless

hush

quiet

just Silence...

i hope you're learning to

Listen

and

Understand.

Simple Arithmetic

My Hopes + My Dreams + My Desires = You

My Desires

plus

My Dreams

plus

My Hopes

equals

You

My Desires + My Hopes + My Dreams = You

My Dreams

plus

My Desires

plus

My Hopes

equals

You

My Dreams + My Hopes + My Desires = You

No matter which way I try to add it,

My Hopes, Dreams & Desires

all equal

You

Subconscious Mind

*In
our
SUBCONSCIOUS
MIND,
like space,
it is without limitation...*

*like **GOD**
there is no up and there is no down...
there is no front and there is no back...
there is no left and there is no right...
everything
is in the
center*

EXCEPT

CONSCIOUSNESS

Temporary Blindness

If
"What U See Is What U Get..."
then,
sometimes we must all suffer

TEMPORARY

B

L

I

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D

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E

S

S

The Our Glass

if i could take

***ALL** the sand in the world,*

and fill a glass of time...

it could only begin to reflect

-The Moments

-The Hours

-The Time

that i would like to spend with

YOU

The Right Time Is Now!

Time is timed by the

Time it takes to

Time

Time.

You cannot

Time

Time because you don't

have enough

Time to

Time

Time.

Time was here before you

and

Time will be here

after your

Time.

Time can only be timed by

Time.

So don't waste your

Time waiting on the right

Time.

The right

Time *is now!*

Because,

Time *will always be here...*

But you'll never know

when "your"

Time

is done.

The “Whether” Report

*On the morning of
Friday, July Second,
Two Thousand Twenty One in
Los Angeles, California*

The Weather Report

forecasted:

*mostly clear
with a high of 84 degrees
and a low of 64 degrees
0 inches precipitation
air quality 60 - moderate
visibility 10 miles
barometer 29.91 PSI
with winds light and variable.*

At Ten O'clock PM

The Weather Report

*further estimated the conditions
as follows:*

*Feels Like: 64 degrees
Barometer: 29.95 PSI and rising*

Humidity: 83%

Visibility: 10 miles

Dewpoint: 61 degrees

Wind: N 7 miles per hour

Sunrise: 5:46 AM

Sunset: 8:08 PM

However

My Dear,

you won't need to consult

The Weather Report

to forecast for you

“Whether” My Love

*is **Rising,***

because it's clear

*the **Pressure** is mounting*

and

My Love's Temperature

for you is

Sizzling Hot!

Thermostat

there is a cold breeze blowing---
blowing
from my heart to yours
and
from your heart to mine...

P.S.
why don't we
"please"
turn up the
Heat!

Thoughts And Such

Be Mindful

of what you think.

*“For as he thinketh in his heart, so is he;”
as your thoughts are how you make
your inscription to the universe.*

Be Sensitive

of how you feel.

*For your emotions mirror your thoughts
and becomes the instrument
that transcribes your message.*

Be Attentive

of that which you assert.

*For your utterances
makes public your emotions
and becomes your self-produced broadcast
for everyone to hear.*

Be Careful

of what you do.

*For your actions are the by-products of your
thoughts, emotions, and utterances
and becomes your
autobiographical performance*

*which lies permanently recorded
in the library of the creator...*

so

Be Mindful

of

THOUGHTS

AND

SUCH...

*“For as he thinketh in his heart, so is he;”
is a quote from the KJV of the Bible. Proverbs23:27*

Waiting For A Miracle

Forever is not too long to

Wait For A Miracle...

nevertheless,

if ever you tire,

just lean back

and

I will be there

to catch

You.

Was Missing?

*we made **Love**
and i came---
never having said
I Love You.*

*we made **Love**
and u came---
never having said
You Love Me.*

didn't it seem like

was missing?

^

^

^

^

^

^

Something

What Must I Do?

What Must I Do

TO SHOW YOU THAT I LOVE YOU?

*must i wait until i escort you to the movies
to be able to put my arms around you
because it's considered
romantically and politically correct behavior?*

Or

*may i put my arms around you
simply because i get the urge to feel
the warmth and reassurance of your caress
while strolling down the walkway of
a crowded shopping mall?*

What Must I Do

TO SHOW YOU THAT I LOVE YOU?

*must i have my secretary order you flowers
months in advance
via some*

*"Silver Gold Platinum Uranium 235
Universal Intergalactic Express Card,"
with the flowers being delivered to you automatically
upon the first day of every month*

&

*on every appropriate holiday as determined
by "Hallmark" or "FTD"
without me even giving it a thought*

&

*by the time you receive them,
i would've already forgotten that flowers
were even being sent?*

Or

*can i buy you a single rose
that i deliver myself on Wednesday
during the middle of the week
for no other reason than i thought
that it might make you smile,
and the fact that, i couldn't afford
two dozen long stem roses in a gold box
with a card attached with some pre-printed message on it
with my name signed by someone else?*

What Must I Do

TO SHOW YOU THAT I LOVE YOU?

*must i contract the Universal Amphitheater
to do a live concert*

&

*dedicate a song to you that
i really wrote about somebody else
to impress you in front of all my friends?*

Or

*can i present you with an idea that i wrote on a napkin,
that you truly inspired*

&

*try to hum the melody softly and sweetly in your ear
when we're all by ourselves,
despite the fact, that i know, that you know,
i can't sing?*

What Must I Do

TO SHOW YOU THAT I LOVE YOU

*must i wait until our eighteenth "official date"
on the twenty-six week anniversary of our affair,
while your moon is in Aquarius
and
my biorhythms are at their peak
as we exit the s-t-r-e-t-c-h limousine for dinner
at Providence
under candlelight with violins playing
while Hollywood stars kiss-up to each other
all around us*

just so that i may have the right ambiance

to get up the nerve to say

I Love You?

Or

can i just say

I Love You

at any time i feel it...

even after i personally drive up and park the car myself

while we go inside to enjoy a Big Mac and Fries

while little kids make noise playing with the toys

they were given in their

"Happy Meals?"

So please, tell me,

What Must I Do

TO SHOW YOU THAT I LOVE YOU?

took you that long to answer huh?

well, i guess i better

see what's playing at the movies,

have my secretary call FTD,

rehearse the band,

arrange for a limo,

&

make reservations at Providence!

At You Have For Me

*There is
no longer a need
to **protect** you from
other men---*

*Trying to keep you
from giving
"what's mine"
away...*

*For what you have
for me,
you could never give
to someone else.*

*Because,
only i
possess the key
to open*

What You Have For Me...

When I Am Loving

when I am Loving

and feel loved,

i feel better---

and

it manifests itself

in everything i do.

When I Fell In Love With U

when

I

fell in Love with

U...

I

slipped & broke

My

Heart.

Where Have You Been?

*where have you been all my life,
where in the **HELL** were you?
i've been looking all over for you.
i've searched the*

***urban centers**
and **the suburbs**,
the
hilltops
and **the valleys**.*

*i've betrayed friends and befriended betrayers
searching for clues to your whereabouts.
where in the **HELL** were you?
who gave you permission to leave?
you knew damn well i needed you!*

*i've listened closely for sounds of you.
i've hired bloodhounds to track your scent.
i've reached far beyond the clouds to no avail
and
i've embarrassed myself approaching others;*

***thinking it was you,**
hoping it was you,
and cursing them*

for not being you...

where were you?

how dare you have the audacity to

desert me,

vacate,

vanish...

leaving me with

no forwarding address,

no phone number,

no way for me

to get in-touch with you...

but then, at last, finally,

while glancing through

some old books i found,

in the cellar,

in the corner,

in the dust...

i began reading...

“Ask and it shall be given...”

so i questioned---

and you answered

with resonance.

“Seek and you shall find...”

so i sought---

and there you were

as bright as the sun.

“Knock and it shall be opened unto you...”

so i rapped about the door---

and you opened it wide.

“Man know thyself...”

so i turned and looked at me---

and then, i found you!

now i must apologize...

i was just looking for you

in all the wrong places

for you have been with me

all the time...

On The Inside.

While You Are There

it's not

Always

*how **Early** you come...*

nor is it

Always

*how **Late** you stay...*

but,

Sometimes,

it's just what you do

While You Are There.

Window-Shop

You

can not

"Window-Shop"

when searching

to find

Yourself.

You

must go

inside

to

feel,

touch,

and

try the garments on.

Wishing To Be Close To You

*There are Times
when i think of being in **Heaven**---
There are Moments
when i've dreamed of being truly **Free**---
And i've Paused...
imagining living in the **Garden of Eden**---*

*But i've spent
Hours upon Hours
just
Wishing To Be Close To You.*

You

There are
dandelions
and...
there are ROSES.

There are
house fly's
and...
there are BUTTERFLY'S.

There are
stones
and...
there are DIAMONDS.

There is
pleasure
and...
there is JOY.

There is
silence

R. Ray Barnes

and...

*there is **PEACE.***

There are

angels

and...

there is

YOU.

Youmeyoumeyoume

the residue from
your
Love & Friendship
has
*permeated **My Spirit,***
*infiltrated **My Being,***
*seeped into **My Soul...***
&
now
YOU** have become a part of **ME

Your Love

if it took all i had to have

Your Love...

then,

Your Love

would be

all that i would have...

